21-TEAM FOOTBALL TOURNAMENT

Group stage • 16-team Round of 16 • Quarterfinals • Semifinals • Final

1. Group arrangement

GROUP A	GROUP B	GROUP C	GROUP D	GROUP E
Team A1: _____	Team B1: _____	Team C1: _____	Team D1: _____	Team E1: _____
Team A2: _____	Team B2: _____	Team C2: _____	Team D2: _____	Team E2: _____
Team A3: _____	Team B3: _____	Team C3: _____	Team D3: _____	Team E3: _____
Team A4: _____	Team B4: _____	Team C4: _____	Team D4: _____	Team E4: _____
				Team E5: _____
4 teams	4 teams	4 teams	4 teams	5 teams

2. Qualification rules

Group	Teams qualifying	Number
Group A	1st, 2nd and 3rd place	3
Group B	1st, 2nd and 3rd place	3
Group C	1st, 2nd and 3rd place	3
Group D	1st, 2nd and 3rd place	3
Group E	1st, 2nd and 3rd place	3
All groups	Best 4th-place team across all five groups	1
TOTAL	**16 teams advance to the knockout stage**	**16**

Important fairness rule: Groups A-D have four teams each, while Group E has five. To compare 4th-place teams fairly, rank them by points per match, goal difference per match, goals scored per match, then fair-play record. If still tied, use a pre-announced draw.

ROUND OF 16 AND KNOCKOUT BRACKET

Use the group positions below after the group stage to identify every Round of 16 fixture.

3. Round of 16 fixtures

Match	First team	vs	Second team	Winner advances to
R16-1	Group A 1st	vs	Group C 3rd	Quarterfinal 1
R16-2	Group B 1st	vs	Group D 3rd	Quarterfinal 2
R16-3	Group C 1st	vs	Group E 3rd	Quarterfinal 3
R16-4	Group D 1st	vs	Group A 3rd	Quarterfinal 4
R16-5	Group E 1st	vs	Group B 3rd	Quarterfinal 4
R16-6	Group A 2nd	vs	Group D 2nd	Quarterfinal 3
R16-7	Group B 2nd	vs	Group E 2nd	Quarterfinal 2
R16-8	Group C 2nd	vs	Best 4th-place team	Quarterfinal 1

4. Knockout bracket

QUARTERFINALS	SEMIFINALS	FINAL	CHAMPION

KNOCKOUT BRACKET

QF1 Winner R16-1 vs Winner R16-8	**SF1** Winner QF1 vs Winner QF2	**FINAL** Winner SF1 vs Winner SF2	**CHAMPION** _____
QF2 Winner R16-2 vs Winner R16-7			
QF3 Winner R16-3 vs Winner R16-6	**SF2** Winner QF3 vs Winner QF4		
QF4 Winner R16-4 vs Winner R16-5			

Match count: 34 group-stage matches + 15 knockout matches (8 Round of 16, 4 quarterfinals, 2 semifinals, 1 final) = 49 total matches.

Knockout path: QF1 = R16-1 winner vs R16-8 winner; QF2 = R16-2 winner vs R16-7 winner;
QF3 = R16-3 winner vs R16-6 winner; QF4 = R16-4 winner vs R16-5 winner.
SF1 = QF1 winner vs QF2 winner; SF2 = QF3 winner vs QF4 winner.